



Create an impressive panorama in minutes using Photomerge in Photoshop CS!

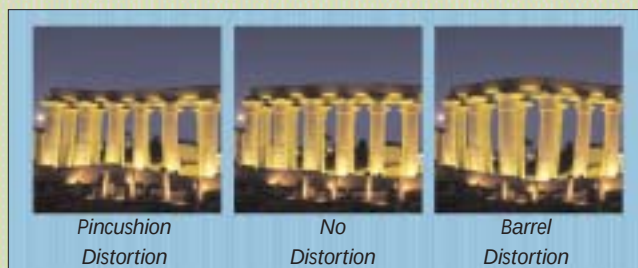
your images identified and adjusted comes up. Click OK to accept and use the Crop tool to crop out unnecessary portions.

Visit www.panoguide.com—a Web site dedicated to creating panoramas, for more tips and software.

Distortion correction

Distortion in photographs could be Barrel distortion—a lens effect that leaves photos with a spherical distortion at the centre, or it could be Pincushion distortion, which

results in images that are pinched in the centre. Distortion in photographs could be Barrel distortion—a lens effect that leaves photos with a spherical distortion at the centre, or it could be Pincushion distortion, which



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An easy solution to correct this would be to use the Panorama Tools plug-in for Photoshop that can be downloaded from <http://home.no.net/dmaurer/~dersch/index.htm>. Open the ZIP

file, and extract the pano12.dll file in the folder where Photoshop is installed. Now, extract all the files inside the 'Photoshop Plugin' in the ZIP file to the Photoshop Plug-Ins or Filters directory. Restart Photoshop and open the photo in need of correction. First, go to **Filter > Panorama Tools > Correct** to bring up the 'Correct Options' dialog box. Select Radial Shift, and click on the option next to it to bring up the 'Set Polynomial Coefficients for Radial Correction' dialog box. Set 'a' and 'c' to zero for all colours, and choose a value for 'b' and 'd' such that their values add up to one. The values for 'b' should be neg-

ative to correct barrel distortion, and positive to rectify pincushion distortions. Start with 0.015 for 'b' and 0.085 for 'd' to correct pincushion, and -0.015 and +1.015 for barrel distortion. Increase or decrease the values gradually until the

Warning!

There are two ways to rotate images in Windows XP. You can right-click on the thumbnail view in Windows Explorer and choose Rotate Clockwise or 'Rotate Counter Clockwise', or use the rotate image button in Windows Picture and Fax Viewer. However, every time an image is rotated, it's saved, which results in some loss of quality. Thus, make it a point to use specialised photo-editing software that save only the final image. If you use Photoshop, it would be best to keep saving the image that is being worked upon in the PSD format. Save it in the JPEG format only when you're done with all the editing. The use of the rotate image function in Windows XP should be the last step of your editing process.

Image resolution

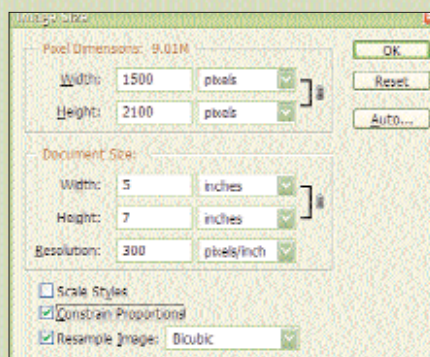
Perhaps the most important

thing to keep in mind while printing images is the resolution. Ideally, a 4 x 6 inches photo should have a resolution of at least 800 x 600. For 5 x 7 prints, it should be 1024 x 768 and for 8 x 10 prints, it should be 1600 x 1200 pixels. Furthermore, you need to have a dpi of 300 for sharper, clearer prints. Use Photoshop to change all these parameters. Access them by going to **Image > Image Size**.

Tinting black and white photos

Using photo-editing applications, you can add colour to black and white photos. Open the image in Photoshop. Go to **Image > Mode**, and ensure that the colour mode is RGB or CMYK. Now, press and hold down [Shift] and use the Lasso tool to select a certain area, say, the skin of the photographed person. That done, go to **Image > Adjustments > Variations** and adjust the levels to obtain the desired colour. Now, select other elements in the photograph and adjust the colour variations in the same manner. Use the Path tool for better control over selections.

Finally, create a new layer with 'soft light' blending mode and 85 per cent opacity. Now, use the dodge and burn tool to lighten and darken the



Adjust image resolution before printing



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